Récoltes et Semailles

Lessons to Learn from a Life

Ali ALMASI

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RS (en.), Section 2.1:

> When I was little, I liked going to school. The same teacher taught us reading, writing, arithmetic, and singing (he accompanied us with a small violin), and he even told us about prehistoric men and the discovery of fire. I do not ever recall being bored at school during those days. There was the magic of numbers, that of words, of signs, and of sounds. That of rhymes as well, through songs and small poems. There seemed to be, within rhymes, a mystery that extended beyond words. I believed this until the day somebody told me that there was a simple "trick" to it—that rhyme was simply when one ends two consecutive spoken movements with the same syllable, so that, as if by magic, these phrases became verses. It was a revelation!
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> At home, where I found a good audience, I amused myself for weeks or months on end by making verses. At one point, I even started exclusively speaking in rhymes. That period has passed, fortunately. Yet even to this day, I still sometimes write poems—but without trying to force the rhyme if it doesn't seem to come by itself.
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> On another occasion, an older friend who was already in high school taught me about negative numbers. It was also a fun game, although I rapidly exhausted it. And then there were crosswords—I spent days and weeks constructing them, ever more interwoven. Within that game, the magic of form, that of signs, and that of words found themselves combined. But even that passion subsided without

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> I spent a fair amount of time, including class time (shh...), solving math problems. The ones in the book soon became insufficient—perhaps because they started to resemble one another after a while, but mostly, I believe, because they seemed to come out of the blue à la queue-leu-leu, with no indication of where they came from or where they were going. These were the book's problems, not mine.

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